



Harassing communist targets

The USS *New Jersey* fires shells into North Vietnam from the Gulf of Tonkin. The *New Jersey* was a heavy bombardment battleship, equipped with 16-inch guns.

“They are **tigers in every respect** ... Tales of their courage are **legendary.**”

REAR ADMIRAL ELMO R. ZUMWALT, DESCRIBING THE BROWN WATER NAVY, 1969

» AFTER

The US Navy played a vital role in US retaliatory action following North Vietnam's Easter Offensive in 1972.

LINEBACKER RAIDS

The US Navy took part in the **Linebacker bombing campaign**, unleashed on North Vietnam after the Easter Offensive in 1972. This and the Navy's mining of **Haiphong Harbor** increased pressure on North Vietnam to accept a negotiated peace settlement.

LAST FORCE OUT

Long after most US ground units had withdrawn from Vietnam, the US Navy continued to provide **advisory, logistical**, and even **combat support** to the South Vietnamese. Navy ships stationed off shore provided the last hope to civilians seeking refuge during the **fall of Saigon**.